



Forlorn Oath

Monster Hunter Wilds

PC (Steam) · Game version 1.042.00.01 (August 2026)

18 mods · Fluffy Mod Manager + REFramework · Six Personas

Compiled August 2026 — for the last version of the game

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1 Installation

Everything you need to go from a vanilla install to a fully modded hunt — with the right mod manager, the right framework, and a setup that survives the game’s steady stream of updates.

1.1 What you need

- *Monster Hunter Wilds on PC (Steam)*, updated to the current build. This guide is written against **1.042.00.01** (released August 7, 2026). Steam updates automatically; check the version on the title screen before installing.
- *Fluffy Mod Manager* — the community-standard mod manager for Monster Hunter Wilds and every other RE Engine title. Download it from [Nexus Mods](#) (site-wide “Fluffy Mod Manager” page; current version 3.081). It installs, backs up, enables, and disables mods without you ever hand-editing the game folder.
- *REFramework* — the modding framework that almost every script mod in this list runs on. Download the latest **nightly build** from its [GitHub releases page](#) — the Nexus copy is frequently outdated, and an outdated `dinput8.dll` is the number one cause of black screens after a game update.
- A *Nexus Mods account* (free) — every mod in Chapter 2 is hosted on Nexus.

Good to know

This list targets the **last** version of the game as it exists today. The paid expansion *Monster Hunter Wilds: Ascendance* was announced in June 2026 for a 2027 release — it is not out yet, so none of the mods here assume it. When it lands, expect a fresh wave of updates and a new version of this guide.

1.2 The mod manager: Fluffy Mod Manager 5000

Monster Hunter Wilds mods come in two flavors: **loose-file mods** (REFramework scripts that drop into `reframework/autorun/`) and **PAK mods** (texture and asset overrides that load via REFramework’s loose-file loader). Fluffy Mod Manager handles both: you drag a downloaded archive into the window, it installs it into its own mods folder with automatic backups, and a single click enables or disables it.

Tip

Fluffy Mod Manager is the right tool for an avid modder here because it is the tool the RE Engine scene actually uses: every mod page in Chapter 2 is written against it, it keeps a pristine backup of every file it touches, and its per-mod toggles let you A/B test without touching the game folder.

1.2.1 Where the files live

- *Game folder*: `Steam\steamapps\common\MonsterHunterWilds\` — contains `MonsterHunterWilds.exe`, `dinput8.dll` (REFramework), and the `reframework\` folder.
- *REFramework scripts*: `MonsterHunterWilds\reframework\autorun\` — one `.lua` file (or subfolder) per script mod.
- *REFramework plugins*: `MonsterHunterWilds\reframework\plugins\` — `.dll` plugins such as `reframework-d2d`.
- *Fluffy’s managed mods*: Fluffy stores archives in its own `Games\MonsterHunterWilds\Mods\` folder and deploys the enabled ones into the game folder for you.

1.3 Installation, step by step

1. *Launch the game once, vanilla*. Generate your settings, confirm the build reads 1.042.00.01, and reach the title screen. This also proves your install is healthy before anything modded touches it.

2. *Install REFramework*. Download the latest nightly from [GitHub](#), extract `dinput8.dll`, and drop it next to `MonsterHunterWilds.exe`. Launch the game once — you should be able to press Insert in-game and see the REFramework menu.
3. *Enable the loose file loader*. In the REFramework menu, open **Settings** and make sure **Enable Loose File Loader** is checked. Without it, PAK-based mods (none in this list, but worth knowing) and some script features will not load.
4. *Install Fluffy Mod Manager*. Download from [Nexus](#), extract, and run `Modmanager.exe`. Pick **Monster Hunter Wilds** from the game list; point it at your Steam library if it does not find the game automatically.
5. *Install the two libraries*. Download **CatLib** (mod 65) and the overlay's renderer **REFramework Direct2D** — either the HDR-aware Wilds build (mod 4033) if you play in HDR, or the classic build from the [Rise](#) page (version 1.3.0+) otherwise. Drag each archive into Fluffy and enable it. These are dependencies, not gameplay — install them first.
6. *Install the mods from Chapter 2*. Download each archive, drag it into Fluffy Mod Manager, and enable it. The modlist chapter notes the handful that need configuration after first launch.
7. *Configure in-game*. Start the game, press Insert, and open **Script Generated UI**. That is where every REFramework script in this list exposes its options — Auto Restock, the Overlay, Disable Post Processing Effects, and the rest. Settings persist automatically.
8. *Verify*. Hunt something small. Confirm the overlay draws, weakness icons appear in the map, damage numbers render, and the image looks the way the visuals chapter intends.

1.4 Optional: the HDR/grading stack

Two entries in the visuals chapter — **RenoDX** and the fog tweak — sit on top of the base install:

- **RenoDX** (mod 202) requires **ReShade with add-on support** (download from [reshade.me](#), select DirectX 12, install into the game folder). It rewrites the game's own shader pipeline — it is not a ReShade effect preset. Its virus-scan note is a known false-positive pattern from AV software; the code is open source. Install REFramework first, then ReShade, then extract RenoDX next to the game's `.exe`.
- **Tweak In-Game Volumetric Fog(s)** (mod 455) is a plain REFramework script — no extra tools.

If you skip RenoDX, the base visual stack (Chapter 2) still stands on its own.

1.5 Keeping the list alive after updates

Wilds receives regular title updates, and every update is a moment your mods can break. The drill:

1. *After Steam updates the game, check the version*. If it is no longer 1.042.00.01, expect a compatibility window.
2. *Update REFramework first*. Delete `dinput8.dll`, download the newest nightly, relaunch. This fixes the majority of black screens and startup crashes on its own.
3. *Then update the scripts*. CatLib, the Overlay, and the visuals scripts are the ones that track game versions most closely (their version numbers literally mirror game patches, e.g. the weakness icons mod versions as 1.041.x).
4. *Re-test*. If something misbehaves, disable mods one at a time in Fluffy to isolate it — never assume; test.

1.6 Troubleshooting

- *Black screen or instant crash on launch* — outdated REFramework after a game update. Delete `dinput8.dll` (and `re2_fw_config.txt`), reinstall the latest nightly from GitHub.
- *Mods not loading* — check that Enable Loose File Loader is on in the REFramework menu; confirm the script's `.lua` sits directly in `reframework\autorun\` (not in a nested folder).
- *Overlay missing* — the Overlay needs CatLib **and** a Direct2D build; if you play in HDR, the plain Rise `d2d` renders wrong colors, so use mod 4033. Verify all three are enabled in Fluffy.
- *Frame-gen flicker in menus* — a known quirk of the post-processing script when local exposure is on and blurred luminance is off; flip one of those two settings (see the script's own notes).

- *Still broken?* — Verify game files (Steam → right-click Monster Hunter Wilds → Properties → Installed Files → Verify integrity), then disable all mods in Fluffy and test vanilla. Re-enable one at a time.

2 The Modlist

Eighteen verified mods (seventeen required, one optional) for game version 1.042.00.01. Every entry was checked against its live Nexus Mods page (author, mod id, description, last-update date) at the time of writing. None of them make the hunt easier or hand you power — they remove busywork, reveal information, sharpen the image, and let you read the monsters better.

2.1 The Oath's rules

This list exists to deepen and modernize the experience. Every entry must earn its place against four pillars:

- *Quality of life* — remove repetition and menu busywork, never remove challenge.
- *Interface & information* — reveal what the vanilla UI hides, so decisions become informed instead of guessed.
- *Visuals & clarity* — sharper, cleaner, better-graded image.
- *Details* — the small touches that make the world and the hunt legible.

Hard exclusions: anything that changes damage, monster stats, drops, item economy, or skill numbers — those are cheats or difficulty toggles, not depth. Anything labeled “cheat” or “trainer” by its author. Anything that extends buffs, auto-plays combat, or removes the need to prepare.

Good to know

A note on “more AI”: Monster Hunter Wilds runs on the RE Engine, and the community has *no stable mod that rewrites monster or Palico AI* — building one is technically very hard, and none has shipped. The “more AI” pillar is served honestly here in two ways: the game’s own **Support Hunter** system (NPC companions you can summon — Chapter 3 explains how to use them well), and information mods that make the monsters’ behavior readable (weakness icons, damage analysis, hitzone colors), so you fight *with* the AI’s logic instead of against a wall of guesswork. If a real AI overhaul ever ships, it will be added here.

2.2 Frameworks & tools (install first)

The foundation every other entry stands on. These are dependencies — install them before anything else (Chapter 1 walks through the order).

REFramework

by praydog

Pillar: Foundation — the loader and scripting API

What it does: The modding framework for RE Engine games: a Lua scripting API, fixes for anti-tamper frame-time spikes, FOV/ultrawide options, freecam, timescale, and the in-game menu (Insert) where every script mod exposes its settings. Install from the nightly releases on GitHub for the newest game patches.

Why it’s in the Oath: Almost every mod in this list is a REFramework script; the framework itself also removes the game’s micro-stutters, which is the single biggest ‘modernize the feel’ win available.

Compatibility: Nexus copy lags — always use the GitHub nightly. Uninstall = delete dinput8.dll from the game folder. Updated continuously; re-install after every title update.

CatLib

by lingsamuel

Pillar: Foundation — shared utility library

What it does: A collection of shared utility scripts that the author's mods depend on. It does nothing on its own; it just needs to be present (version 1.13+, updated February 2026).

Why it's in the Oath: The dependency that unlocks the whole QoL and overlay family below — one install, many mods.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework. Install once; do not install multiple copies. Drop the `\_CatLib` folder into `reframework/autorun/`.

REFramework Direct2D

by lingsamuel (fork of cursey's reframework-d2d)

Pillar: Foundation — overlay renderer

What it does: Lets REFramework scripts draw 2D UI (health bars, text) on screen. This Wilds build adds HDR support so the overlay renders correctly on HDR displays; the classic build lives on the Rise page (mod 134, version 1.3.0+).

Why it's in the Oath: Required by MHWilds Overlay. Pick the HDR build if you play in HDR, the classic otherwise — never both.

Compatibility: `reframework-d2d.dll` → `reframework/plugins/`, `reframework-d2d.lua` → `reframework/autorun/`. Requires REFramework.

2.3 Quality of life (8)

The busywork removers. Nothing here changes a single damage number — it removes the **menus**, the **walks**, and the **waiting** between hunts so your time goes into hunting.

Auto Restock

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — preparation automation

What it does: Automatically restocks your item pouch from the item box when you accept a quest, using a loadout chosen per weapon type or per equipment set. Configure rules in Script Generated UI > Auto Restock.

Why it's in the Oath: The single most-played prep action in the game becomes a rule you set once. Preparation still matters — you still pick the loadout — but re-clicking it fifty times does not.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. Version 1.3 (December 2025).

Auto Meal

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — preparation automation

What it does: Automatically cooks and eats the meal set you configured for your current weapon or equipment loadout before a hunt — and lets you eat without consuming ingredients if you so choose.

Why it's in the Oath: Meal buffs are a real decision (which ingredients, which skills); remembering to apply them every hunt is not. The decision stays, the forgetting goes.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Auto Fix Camps

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — camp upkeep

What it does: Automatically repairs broken pop-up camps when you open the map.

Why it's in the Oath: Camp upkeep is housekeeping with no decision in it. Auto Fix Camps keeps your network of camps — and their fast-travel points — alive without a repair trip.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Auto Sharpen Weapons

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — post-hunt upkeep

What it does: Automatically sharpens your weapon after a quest ends or when you leave combat.

Why it's in the Oath: Sharpening mid-fight is a core tactical decision (do you risk the whetstone?); sharpening at camp is a chore. The mod removes only the chore.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Auto Hide Mantles

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — visual clutter

What it does: Hides the visual appearance of mantles while their effects stay fully active.

Why it's in the Oath: Mantles are some of the most visually obnoxious gear in the game; you wear them for the effect, not the look. Pure presentation, zero gameplay change.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Better Camps

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — camp capacity

What it does: Increases the maximum number of pop-up camps you can maintain, and repairs broken camps automatically after 20 seconds.

Why it's in the Oath: More camps means more fast-travel options and more map coverage — a logistics upgrade, not a combat one. You still have to place and defend them.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Skip Intro Logos

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — launch flow

What it does: Skips the Capcom and other publisher logos on startup so the game reaches the title screen faster.

Why it's in the Oath: The least interesting thirty seconds of every session. Strictly convenience.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Disable Near Fade and Camera Zoom In

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL / camera clarity

What it does: Stops monsters, terrain, and NPCs from fading out (turning transparent) when the camera gets close, and disables the camera's automatic zoom-in during combat.

Why it's in the Oath: Large monsters up close vanish into transparency exactly when you need to read their telegraphs; the combat zoom further disorients. Both are camera behavior, not game balance — removing them makes fights readable.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. Version 1.2.1 (April 2025). Configure via Script Generated UI > Disable Near Fade.

2.4 Interface & information (3)

These turn guessing into reading. None change a single number — they surface numbers the game already computes.

Monster Weakness Icon Indicator

by celluloid

Pillar: UI — monster knowledge

What it does: Shows each monster's elemental weaknesses as icons directly on the map and in the field guide, so you can see at a glance what to bring instead of opening the guide mid-expedition.

Why it's in the Oath: Element choice is a real preparation decision — the mod just makes the information you already own visible where you need it. Optimized for Fluffy Mod Manager usage.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework. Version mirrors the game patch (1.041.02.00, February 2026). Tagged 'fair and balanced' by the author.

MHWilds Overlay

by lingsamuel

Pillar: UI — hunt telemetry

What it does: An in-game overlay showing boss HP, per-hunter DPS, a stats table (damage, crit rate, hitzone exploitation, status buildup), and an experimental buff/damage reporter.

Why it's in the Oath: The 'modernize' flagship: the hunt becomes measurable. You can see whether your hits actually land on good hitzones, which buffs carry your damage, and whether you are actually contributing — information that turns vague hunts into learning loops.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework + a Direct2D build. Version 1.14 (February 2026). Designed for and tested in single-player hunts — configure it via Script Generated UI > MHWilds Overlay.

Enhanced Damage Numbers

by lingsamuel

Pillar: UI — hitzone feedback

What it does: Colors your damage numbers by the real hitzone value — e.g. showing when Weakness Exploit or Mind's Eye are actually triggering — and can split physical and elemental damage into separate numbers (off by default).

Why it's in the Oath: The game's damage numbers hide *why* you hit hard or soft. This makes the hitzone system legible: you learn which parts to aim at by watching the colors, which is exactly the kind of depth this list exists to add.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib 1.6+ + REFramework. Version 1.6 (December 2025). Tested by the author in single player.

2.5 Visuals & clarity (4)

The image work. Wilds' default look is heavy on fog, lens distortion, and washed-out grading — these entries clean it up without touching gameplay.

Disable Post Processing Effects

by TonWonton

Pillar: Visuals — clarity & performance headroom

What it does: A REFramework script to toggle or tune the post-processing stack: TAA, color correction, lens distortion, local exposure, volumetric fog, film grain, sharpening, plus custom contrast and brightness for game and UI. Settings save and reload automatically.

Why it's in the Oath: The single biggest 'sharper picture' win for Wilds: it removes the blur and the washed-out grade while leaving you full control. Its defaults (lens distortion off, blurred luminance off) already clean up the image.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework. Version 1.3.3 (July 2025). Known quirk: with frame gen on, local exposure ON + blurred luminance OFF can flicker in menus — flip one of the two. Covers everything the stand-alone lens-distortion mod does, so that mod is not needed.

Tweak In-Game Volumetric Fog(s)

by TheFuzzy

Pillar: Visuals — atmosphere tuning

What it does: Lets you tune the volumetric fog's resolution, ambient light, fog culling distance, and near-fade distance — reducing the fog's obscuring effect *without* switching it off entirely.

Why it's in the Oath: Wilds' fog is beautiful but heavy-handed: it hides monsters that are 40 meters away. This keeps the atmosphere while returning visibility — the 'details' pillar in one slider set.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework (build 01090+). Version 1.0.0 (March 2025). Works alongside Disable Post Processing Effects; recommended companion by both authors.

Persistent Buff Glow Removal

by Peasly Wellbott

Pillar: Visuals — effect clutter

What it does: Configurably suppresses the pulsing glow effects on your hunter from item buffs, skills, weapons, and mantles — plus optional hiding of blights, frenzy effects, and elemental hit flashes.

Why it's in the Oath: Buff glows are the visual noise of every hunt. With it off by default for the worst offenders and fully configurable, you see the monster, not your own aura.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework. Version 2.0.3 (July 2025). Options live in Script Generated UI; per-effect toggles, default False for most.

RenoDX — HDR and SDR Fix (optional)

by Ritsu and Kickfister

Pillar: Visuals — grading pipeline

What it does: Rewrites the game's DX12 grading pipeline to fix Wilds' raised blacks and narrow dynamic range in both HDR and SDR, adding real-time controls for tonemapping, paper white, UI brightness, exposure, contrast, and color grading.

Why it's in the Oath: The deep-end visual fix: the game's own color pipeline is the weakest link in its image quality, and this is the only mod that replaces it properly. Optional because it needs ReShade's add-on system and is for players who care about the image enough to tune it.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework + ReShade with add-on support (reshade.me, DirectX 12). Version 4.4.2 (August 2026) — actively maintained. AV may flag the DLL (known false positive; open source). Do not stack with other engine-level shader mods — see the page's troubleshooting.

2.6 Why these mods — and what's deliberately not here

- *No difficulty mods.* Nothing that multiplies monster HP or damage. Challenge in Wilds comes from the hunt itself, not from a slider; the list deepens the game rather than inflating it.
- *No cheats.* No infinite consumables, free crafting, editors, or item injection — those are explicitly outside the Oath.
- *No buff extenders.* Pausing meal timers or extending item buffs would quietly make the game easier; preparation is part of the game.
- *No weapon-moveset tweaks.* A handful of popular mods unlock movesets or remove input delays for specific weapons — they change combat balance per weapon and are out of scope.
- *No dead or redundant entries.* The DirectStorage DLL swap (marked “no longer necessary” by its author), the standalone lens-distortion mod (fully covered by Disable Post Processing Effects), and the “Lite Environment” performance pack (end of support) were all evaluated and rejected at compile time.

3 How to Play

*This chapter assumes you know the shape of Monster Hunter but want to play Wilds **well** with the Oath installed — what to set up before a hunt, how to read the game with the mods' new information, and the strategy behind each of the systems that actually matter.*

3.1 The Oath's reading of the game

The mods are not decoration — they change how you make decisions:

- *Weakness icons* tell you what to bring before you leave camp. Element choice stops being a guess.
- *The Overlay* tells you how the fight is actually going: what share of your damage lands on real hitzones, which statuses are building up, and when a monster is about to die — so you can stop over-cautious play and commit at the right moment.
- *Enhanced Damage Numbers* teach you the hitzone system live: colored numbers where Weakness Exploit triggers, split physical/elemental values when you turn that on. You learn the monster's weak parts by watching your own hits.
- *The visual stack* (post-processing script, fog tweak, glow removal) means you can actually **see** the monster's telegraphs at distance and in weather. Read the tells, not the fog.
- *The QoL stack* removes the between-hunt busywork — restock, meal, camp repair, sharpening — so your session is hunts, not menus.

Good to know

Nothing in the Oath makes a monster die faster or hit softer. The information edge is real, but it is a **skill** edge: the mods show you what is already happening and let you act on it. Play with them for a week and you will be a better hunter — unmodded too, because everything you learned was already in the game.

3.2 The hunt loop

Every hunt in Wilds runs the same skeleton. The mods slot into it:

1. *Prepare*. Eat a meal (Auto Meal handles it from your configured set), confirm your item loadout (Auto Restock restocks it when you take the quest). Check the weakness icons on the map to confirm your element.
2. *Travel*. Call your Seikret. Mark the monster on the map and let auto-navigation carry you — use the ride to sharpen (Auto Sharpen already handled the camp side) and plan your opening.
3. *Track*. Follow the Scoutflies and the monster's trail. Wilds' monsters move between zones; the map shows their current position and direction.
4. *Engage*. Enter Focus Mode to aim attacks at wounds and weak parts. The damage numbers now tell you where you are actually hitting — follow the colored numbers.
5. *Exploit*. Wounds glow red (blue on tempered monsters). A **Focus Strike** on a wound deals bonus damage, breaks it, and usually rewards you with parts or a resource refund. This is Wilds' core combat loop — wound, strike, repeat.
6. *Finish*. Slay or capture. The Overlay's HP bar removes the ambiguity of "is it dying?" — when it limps, it is time to decide: trap, or finish the carve.

3.3 Preparation: where hunts are actually won

The Oath's QoL mods automate the **execution** of preparation — they do not automate the **decisions**. Learn to make them deliberately:

- *The elemental matchup*. Every monster has elemental weaknesses and resistances. The weakness icons put them on the map so you can match your weapon's element (and, later, your decorations) before the hunt starts. Fighting a monster with its **resisted** element is the single most common silent mistake in the game — you will see it in the damage numbers as grey where you expect gold.
- *The meal*. Meals grant a set of buffs and skills that last through the hunt, and different ingredient combinations produce different effects. Cook for the fight: raw damage for a quick kill, defense for a monster you do not know, stamina or elemental resist for the fights that demand them. Auto Meal is configured per weapon type or equipment loadout — build meal sets to match your builds, not a single one-size meal.

- *The item loadout.* Auto Restock pulls a configured item set into your pouch when you accept a quest. The right loadout is a real choice: potions and antidotes for a poisoner, flash pods for fliers, traps and tranq bombs if you intend to capture, dung pods for crowded zones, farcasters for emergencies.
- *The two-weapon identity.* The Seikret carries a second weapon, and you can switch mid-hunt. A common winning pair is one weapon for the monster's weakness and one for its resistance, or a melee weapon plus a ranged one so you can keep fighting when the monster camps in a bad spot.

Tip

Configure Auto Restock and Auto Meal per **weapon type** (Script Generated UI > Auto Restock / Auto Meal). Then switching your loadout for a matchup automatically switches your meal and your pouch — the automation does what you **would** have done anyway, but it never forgets.

3.4 Combat strategy

3.4.1 Commitment and positioning

Every weapon in Wilds is a contract about how long you commit to an attack. The game's difficulty is mostly **reading** — knowing when the monster's turn ends and yours begins:

- *Sheath discipline.* The fastest way to get hit is to attack during the monster's wind-up. If the monster is preparing a charge, roar, or tail spin, your only job is to not be where it lands. Sheathe early; reposition; punish after.
- *Position is a weapon.* Most monsters have a danger zone (front claws, tail arc, breath line) and a safe flank. Learn the safe zone for each monster and stand there: you attack more, dodge less, and create wounds faster.
- *Turn economy.* Monster Hunter fights are a constant exchange of turns. The monster's attack is its turn; your punish window is yours. Weapons with long wind-ups (Great Sword, Hammer) need you to **predict** the end of the monster's turn; fast weapons (Dual Blades, Sword & Shield) can react to it. Play to your weapon's timing, not the monster's aggression.

3.4.2 Hitzones and damage

Damage numbers in Wilds are split between physical and elemental, and each part of a monster takes different amounts of each:

- *Physical damage* favors parts with soft meat values — heads, wings, tails, exposed bellies. Enhanced Damage Numbers colors them gold when Weakness Exploit is live (hitzone value over 45), so you can **see** which parts count.
- *Elemental damage* is a separate, usually smaller, channel. Some monsters are famously element-resistant on their best physical hitzones — if your numbers look gold but the fight feels slow, the monster may be resisting your element.
- *Fixed damage* (gunlance shelling, some special attacks) ignores hitzones entirely — the damage numbers mod marks these red. Useful against monsters with no soft spots, but they do not benefit from Weakness Exploit.
- *Mind's Eye* (which the numbers mod also flags) removes the damage penalty for hitting **hard** parts — worth slotting when a monster's weak point is hard to reach.

The practical loop: watch your own numbers, identify which part is gold, farm that part. Every monster becomes a checklist.

3.4.3 The wound economy

Wounds are Wilds' core loop, and they are a **resource** with timing:

- *Creating wounds.* Focused damage on one part accumulates a wound; the part glows red in Focus Mode (blue on tempered monsters). Different weapons create wounds at different rates — burst weapons (Dual Blades, Bow) create them fast; heavy weapons create fewer, deeper ones.

- *Spending wounds.* A Focus Strike on a wound does big damage, breaks the wound, and refunds resources or drops parts. But a wound is also a **soft spot** — normal attacks on it deal increased damage until it breaks on its own.
- *Timing the pop.* The best time to Focus Strike is when the monster is committed to a long animation (roaring, charging, exhausted), because the strike animation is a commitment too. Popping a wound also staggers the monster — save a wound for the moment the monster is about to escape or enrage, and the stagger becomes a control tool.
- *Wounds as parts.* Breaking wounds drops materials; if you need a rare part, farm the wound on the part that drops it, then break it deliberately (traps are a reliable window).

3.4.4 Counters: offsets and clashes

Wilds gives several weapons a **counter** identity built on timing:

- *Offset attacks* — certain weapon moves, timed against an incoming attack, trigger a counter that staggers the monster and opens a huge punish window. These are the highest-skill, highest-reward reads in the game. Start by practicing on slow, telegraphed attacks (charges, tail slams) before attempting them in live fights.
- *Clashes* — blocking a monster’s charge with a heavy weapon (Lance, Gunlance, Great Sword guard, and others) can lock into a power struggle; winning it topples the monster. Clashes reward **standing your ground** — the Warden persona is built around them.
- *Perfect guards and evades* — some weapons reward frame-perfect defensive timing with counters of their own. Learn one counter per weapon you play; it turns the defensive game into offense.

3.4.5 Status and crowd control

Status effects build up on a hidden gauge that persists through the fight; the Overlay’s status readout shows you the buildup. Each status is a different tactical tool:

- *Poison* — ticking damage over time; strongest on high-HP monsters where the fight will be long.
- *Blast* — an explosive proc after enough buildup; extra burst damage on almost every monster.
- *Paralysis* — freezes the monster in place for a long punish window; the classic “set up the big hit” tool.
- *Sleep* — the monster falls asleep and the **first hit** on it deals massively increased damage. A sleeping monster is your chance to place one huge charged attack (Great Sword true charge, gunlance full burst, a barrel bomb stack). Never wake a monster with a poke.
- *Stun* — from repeated head damage; the monster falls over for a free window. Head-focused builds effectively farm stuns.
- *Riding* (Seikret jumping attacks) — topples the monster on a timer, giving the whole hunt a free damage window.

Tip

Status weapons (and status decorations) pair beautifully with the Overlay’s buildup readout: you can **see** when paralysis is one hit away and hold your strongest attack for it. Status is not a damage increase — it is a **timing** increase.

3.5 The weapons, grouped by strategy

All fourteen weapons are viable and all fourteen share the same core rules; they differ in **when** they want to commit. Try everything in the camp training area, then build an identity:

- *The big reads* — Great Sword, Hammer, Hunting Horn. Slow, massive, and entirely about predicting the end of the monster’s turn. Great Sword charges and Hammer charges need positioning hours; Hunting Horn fights with its melodies (Notes) while playing buffs.
- *The blade dancers* — Sword & Shield, Dual Blades. Fast, reactive, and sticky: they stay on the monster, create wounds quickly, and (Sword & Shield) use items without sheathing. Dual Blades’ Demon Mode is a commitment with a reward.

- *The walls* — Lance, Gunlance. Guard, counter, and never retreat. Lance is the pure poke-and-guard identity; Gunlance trades mobility for shelling (fixed damage) and the explosive full burst.
- *The technical arsenal* — Switch Axe, Charge Blade. Both manage a resource (phials for Charge Blade's sword/shield/axe states; amped state and Power Axe for Switch Axe). High skill ceiling, enormous payoff for clean play.
- *The aerialist* — Insect Glaive. Harvests kinsect extracts (red, white, orange — each grants a different buff) and fights from the air; extract management is the whole game.
- *The ranged line* — Bow, Light Bowgun, Heavy Bowgun. Range, weak-spot precision, and status ammo/coatings. Bow charges shots and rewards mobility; the bowguns add a third ammo economy on top of the normal one. Ranged weapons change the positioning game entirely — you still need to read the monster, but the safe zones are different.

3.6 Monsters and matchups

The Forbidden Lands host five locales — the Windward Plains, the Scarlet Forest, the Oilwell Basin, the Iceshard Cliffs, and the Ruins of Wyveria — and each has its own ecosystem and its own apex predator (Rey Dau in the plains, Uth Duna in the forest, and worse beyond). Learn the **families**, not just the individuals:

- *Wyverns and leviathans* (Rathian-line, Mizutsune, Lagiacrus) — classic patterns: breath attacks, charges, tail arcs. Their tells are big and slow; they punish overcommitment.
- *Brute and fanged monsters* — wrestling patterns: tackles, grapples, and enraged spin cycles. They reward staying mobile and punishing the recovery after a missed grab.
- *Guardians and elder-tier threats* (Arkveld, Zoh Shia, Gogmazios) — the endgame walls. Expect multi-phase fights, elemental shifts, and attacks that demand the full toolkit: offset reads, clash blocks, status windows, and wound discipline.

The matchup strategy is simple in principle: **bring what the icons tell you, aim where the numbers tell you, and know the family's danger zone before the fight starts**. Title updates have added more matchups over time — Mizutsune (April 2025), Lagiacrus and Seregios (June 2025), Gogmazios (December 2025), and various Arch-Tempered challenges — each one a new lesson in the same grammar.

3.7 Weather, seasons, and the environment

Every locale cycles through three states, and the state is a strategy layer:

- *Plenty* — abundant resources, calmer monsters. The best time to gather, fish, and farm endemic life.
- *Fallow* — dry and sparse; some monsters and resources withdraw. Routes change.
- *Inclemency* — storms, sandstorms, magma flows. This is when each locale's **Apex monster** appears and the environment itself becomes a hazard. The strongest hunts happen here.

You can change the weather and time of day by resting at a camp and using the BBQ menu — it costs **Guild Points**, so it is a resource decision, not a freebie. Plan around the cycle: farm in Plenty, hunt apexes in Inclemency, and use Fallow for the monsters that only appear then. The fog and post-processing mods matter most in Inclemency: with the fog tamed, you can actually fight the apex in its storm instead of guessing where it is.

3.8 Camps: your logistics network

- *Base camps* are permanent hubs: item box, smithy access, tent (change equipment, appearance, and loadouts).
- *Pop-up camps* are built with a Camping Kit at marked spots. Each gives a fast-travel point and a rest stop — and monsters can destroy them. Better Camps raises how many you can maintain, and Auto Fix Camps repairs them when you open the map.

Tip

Build pop-up camps near the hunting grounds you farm. A camp on the far side of the locale is worth more than a second camp near base — fast-travel is the difference between a fifteen-minute chase and a five-minute hunt.

3.9 Progression: from the story to the endgame

3.9.1 Low Rank — the story

The story walks you through every locale and system: the Forlorn expedition, your handler Alma, the smithy run by Gemma, and the mystery of the White Wraith. Treat it as the tutorial in disguise — it deliberately introduces one system at a time. Do not rush it: the gear you craft here teaches you the crafting loop that the endgame runs on.

3.9.2 The smithy and crafting

Gemma's forge is where all progression lives:

- *Weapons* branch from ore/bone base trees into monster-specific lines, each with different raw, element, sharpness, and slots. You upgrade along a tree — pick a line and feed it materials. Two weapons of the same tree share progress, so upgrading for one persona's build does not waste the line.
- *Armor* is built per monster: each set carries armor skills plus defense, and pieces have decoration slots. Early sets are stepping stones; the skills they carry (Divine Blessing, Speed Eating, and the rest) matter more than raw defense.
- *Talismans* are forged at the smithy from Chapter 2 onward — a dedicated equipment slot that adds extra skill points. The best talismans are a long-term endgame goal.

3.9.3 Skills, decorations, and buildcraft

Wilds separates skills into two channels, and buildcraft is about balancing both:

- *Weapon skills* live on your weapon and its slots — offensive and weapon-mechanic skills (Artillery for shelling, Charge Master for charged attacks, Focus for Great Sword, Guard for Lance).
- *Armor skills* live on armor — defensive and utility skills (Divine Blessing, Speed Eating, and general buffs).
- *Decorations* (jewels) fill slots on both. Slots come in levels 1–3; a lower-level jewel fits a higher-level slot, never the reverse. Crucially, **weapon decorations only fit weapon slots and armor decorations only fit armor slots** — plan your weapons around the skills they must carry.
- *Set bonuses* activate when you wear a number of pieces from the same armor set; *group skills* are more flexible, activating when three pieces share a group skill even across different sets.
- *Getting decorations*: mostly random appraisal from quest rewards — tempered hunts are the reliable source — plus targeted crafting at the Melding Pot.

Tip

The Overlay's stats table is a buildcraft tool: it shows what share of your damage is physical vs elemental, how often you hit Weakness Exploit zones, and what your buffs actually contribute. Before changing a build, **measure** it — the numbers tell you whether the new skill is earning its slot.

3.9.4 High Rank and beyond

- *High Rank* (after the credits): new monster variants, investigations, and the real gear ladder. HR versions of every monster drop the materials the endgame builds need.
- *Tempered monsters* — stronger variants with glowing wounds (blue in Focus Mode) and better rewards. Hunting tempered monsters is the primary decoration farm; every tempered kill is appraisal loot.
- *Investigations* — randomized quests with modifiers that change rewards and difficulty. The endgame's farming loop: farm the investigation for the parts, decorations, and rare materials you need.

- *Arch-Tempered* — the top-tier challenge variants added through title updates (Arch-Tempered Rey Dau, Uth Duna, Arkveld, and more). Expect the hardest hunts in the game; bring the whole Oath stack.
- *Event quests* — since the 1.042 update, all 26 event quests are playable at any time. They award exclusive gear, layered armor, and event-only materials — the reliable source of the cosmetic endgame.

The current endgame ceiling: Gogmazios (December 2025) added a new endgame gear system, and Arch-Tempered Arkveld (February 2026) sits at the top of the challenge ladder. The **Ascendance** expansion arrives in 2027 and will rewrite this paragraph.

3.10 Economy and upkeep

- *Zenny* — the money. Crafting, upgrading, and meals all drain it. Sell duplicate monster parts you have hundreds of; never sell materials you still need for an upgrade you are chasing.
- *Guild Points* — the expedition’s resource. Resting to change weather, and some services, cost it. Earn it by hunting, gathering, and completing optional quests — it flows in constantly, so spend it on weather control freely.
- *Ingredients* — meal fuel, gathered in the field. Build a stockpile of the ingredients your meal sets use; gather on the way to every hunt (the Horizon Keeper persona makes this a rule).
- *Monster parts* — the real currency. Every hunt yields materials; the field guide tells you which parts drop from which breaks and carves. Target the break, not the kill: a tail carved is a tail you did not have to re-hunt.

3.11 Side systems: the world between hunts

- *Fishing* — rod or capture net. Net-caught fish are fast but do not count for quests or achievements; rod-caught ones do. Big fish (“Whoppers”) trigger a minigame: match the fish’s movements, use the right lure and reeling speed, and force jumpers back down. Fish are ingredients, quest targets, and trophy material.
- *Endemic life* — small creatures caught with the Capture Net. They are sent to the Expedition Command tent at your base camp. Rare species appear only under specific conditions — time of day, weather, season — which makes the weather system double as a **collecting** system. Completing the field guide is a long-term goal with real rewards.
- *Photo mode* — no default hotkey; open it from the Options tab of the main menu (or bind it to your radial menu). In solo play it freezes the game for clean shots. Enable Depth of Field in graphics settings first, or the option is unavailable. With the Oath’s visual stack installed, the Forbidden Lands are worth photographing.
- *The field guide* — the in-game encyclopedia of monsters, materials, and endemic life. The weakness icons mod puts the combat-relevant part of it on the map; the full guide is still worth completing — it is the checklist for the whole game.

3.12 Your first hunts: a skeleton

A strong opening, whatever your weapon:

1. *The first assignments* are scripted introductions — follow them, and use the training area at camp between them to test the full weapon roster. Pick one weapon and stay with it for the Low Rank story; weapon-switching mid-story slows your gear progress.
2. *Upgrade constantly*. Every time you unlock a new monster, check the smithy: your weapon line and a fresh armor set are worth more than any skill you could grind for.
3. *Learn Focus Mode early*. Hold the aim button, watch the wounds appear, and practice Focus Strikes on the low-rank monsters where the stakes are low.
4. *Build the meal and loadout habits now*. Configure Auto Meal and Auto Restock per weapon type in the first session — they pay off for the whole game.
5. *Don’t beeline*. Wilds’ story is the tutorial; skipping systems (camps, fishing, endemic life, side quests) to reach High Rank faster just makes High Rank harder. The endgame assumes you know the loop.

3.13 Pitfalls that end runs

- *Fighting the wrong element.* Grey damage numbers are a silent gear check. Check the icons before you leave camp.
- *Overcommitting on reads.* A missed Great Sword charge or an ill-timed offset costs you more than the monster's turn — it costs your positioning. Practice reads on slow monsters first.
- *Ignoring sharpness.* Hitting with a dull weapon is a massive damage loss. Sharpen between engagements (Auto Sharpen handles after-quest; mid-fight is your call).
- *Skipping meals.* A hunt without a meal is a hunt fighting with one hand tied. Auto Meal exists so this never happens.
- *Wandering without a plan.* Every hunt should have a target part, a break, and a capture/slay decision. The Overlay makes the decision visible; make it before the monster is limping.
- *Hoarding Guild Points.* They are for spending — the weather is a tool, not a tax.
- *Hunting in the wrong season.* Want a rare endemic creature or an apex? Check the weather, rest to set it, then go. Farming the wrong cycle wastes sessions.
- *Chasing the perfect build before the story.* Low Rank gear is disposable; the endgame ladder is where builds matter. Craft for the next fight, not for the final one.
- *Not using the camp network.* A pop-up camp on the far side of the map halves every hunt. Place them early, repair them (Auto Fix Camps), and use them.

3.14 Ten rules for a modded hunt

1. *Update REFramework after every game update, before anything else.* Black screen = old dinput8.dll, nine times out of ten.
2. *Keep the Oath's exclusions in mind* — if a mod sounds like it removes challenge, it does not belong.
3. *Eat before every hunt* (Auto Meal makes this automatic — configure the sets).
4. *Restock before every hunt* (Auto Restock — configure per weapon type).
5. *Read the damage numbers* — gold means Weakness Exploit is live; if you are hitting grey, you are hitting the wrong part.
6. *Fight the weather, don't fight the fog* — with the fog tamed, Inclemency is where the best hunts live.
7. *Capture when you need parts, slay when you need carves* — the Overlay's HP bar makes the decision clean.
8. *Learn two weapons* — the Seikret carries a second; a ranged and a melee identity covers every matchup.
9. *One persona, one save* (Chapter 4) — keep the chronicles from bleeding into each other.
10. *Screenshot the moments* — with the image stack, Wilds is a beautiful game; the Oath just takes the glasses off.

4 Personas

Who are you in the Forbidden Lands? Six ways to play the same modded world — each with a background, and the character-creation choices that make it yours.

4.1 Before you start: how “creation” works in Wilds

Monster Hunter Wilds has no difficulty slider and no class system — your identity comes from the **character creator** and the rules you keep. At creation you choose:

- *The hunter* — name, voice and pitch, posture, skin tone, facial structure, hair (color, gradients, length), eyebrows, eyes, nose, mouth, skin textures (wrinkles, scars), makeup and face paint. Fully editable later at any camp's tent; the deeper edit vouchers live on the title screen.
- *The Palico* — name, fur pattern and colors, ear shapes, eye designs, and voice (traditional Felyne language, or spoken language with your choice of pitch).

- *The Seikret* — name, colors, feather patterns, and decorations. Your mount is your identity on the road.
- *The weapon* — all fourteen are available from the start; the training area at camp lets you try any of them. Each persona leads with one and carries a second on the Seikret.
- *Character creation codes* — the creator is so detailed that players share “recipe” codes; you can paste one in at creation to start from someone else’s look. If you find a face you love for a persona, use its code.

Good to know

All six personas run on the **same** modlist — the personas differ in creation choices, weapons, and self-imposed rules, not in mods. Wilds’ challenge comes from the monster, your gear, and the rules you keep, so each persona’s “house rules” are the real character. Keep one save per persona so you can always return to an old chronicle.

4.2 1 • The Warden of the Forlorn

The Warden of the Forlorn *Weapons: Lance → Gunlance · Focus: standing your ground*

Background. The expedition does not travel because it is safe; it travels because someone holds the line. The Warden is that someone — the veteran who planted the first flag, the hunter who walks into a monster’s charge instead of out of it. Lance is the identity: guard, counter, and the patience to let a monster exhaust itself against your shield. Gunlance is the second act: when patience stops being enough, the shelling starts. The Warden measures a hunt in how few steps they took backwards.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a weathered face with visible scars (skin texture slider), short practical hair, deep voice, low pitch. Name them after a landmark — **Kestrel, Monolith, Barricade**.
- **Palico:** sturdy build, thick fur, a calm eye; name them **Vigil**. Spoken voice, low pitch — a steady presence, not a comedian.
- **Seikret:** earthen tones — dun and slate with minimal decoration. A workhorse mount, not a show pony.
- **Weapons:** start Lance; add Gunlance as the Seikret’s second weapon once you own the basics.
- **House rules:** never roll out of a monster’s attack — block, counter, or take it on the shield; guard the camp — a quest does not end until every Support Hunter stands; at least one Clash won per major hunt.
- **Goal:** every Apex and Arch-Tempered, standing your ground the whole fight.
- **Mods that shine:** Disable Near Fade (see the monster coming, always), the Overlay (know exactly when the monster is about to fall), Persistent Buff Glow Removal (keep your shield read clean), the visual stack.

4.3 2 • The Storm’s Edge

The Storm’s Edge *Weapons: Long Sword → Great Sword · Focus: reading monsters, perfect counters*

Background. Every monster is a language of wind-ups and tells, and the Storm’s Edge speaks it fluently. Long Sword is the conversation: Iai sheathe, counter, Spirit Blade — offense that is really a series of **reads**. The Great Sword is the punctuation: one charged slash placed exactly where the monster’s move leaves it open. The Storm’s Edge hunts slowly and kills quickly: most of the hunt is watching, most of the fight is three perfect hits.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** sharp, angular features; dark hair with a single streak of color (hair gradient slider); medium voice, calm pitch. Name them for weather — **Monsoon, Squall, Kestrel**.
- **Palico:** sleek, dark fur with bright eyes; name them **Flicker**. Felyne language — tradition suits the duelist.
- **Seikret:** storm colors — slate blue and white feathers, lightning-pattern decoration.

- **Weapons:** start Long Sword; carry Great Sword as the second.
- **House rules:** every hunt must include at least one perfect Iai counter and one Offset attack — reads are the point; never use the auto-navigation to chase — walk the monster's own path so you learn its routes; no healing while the monster is enraged (you read it, you own it).
- **Goal:** slay every monster with fewer than N hits taken — the Overlay's stats prove it.
- **Mods that shine:** the Overlay (DPS and hit data prove your reads), Enhanced Damage Numbers (hitzone colors show where the counters should land), Disable Near Fade (see the tell, not the fade), the fog tweak.

4.4 3 • The Wildfire

The Wildfire *Weapons: Dual Blades → Sword & Shield · Focus: relentless aggression, flinches and wounds*

Background. Some hunters study the monster; the Wildfire **overwhelms** it. Dual Blades is a machine-gun of damage that lives on the monster's weak spot and converts every opening into a wound; Sword & Shield is the flexible second gear — item use without sheathing, guard when needed, and the best mounting game in the roster. The Wildfire's philosophy: the monster cannot use its best moves if it never gets a turn. The Overlay exists for this persona — watching the DPS chart climb is the sport.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a young, bright face with face paint (asymmetry slider off — clean, bold marks); short, vivid hair (bright gradient); energetic voice, higher pitch. Name them for fire — **Blaze, Ember, Cinder**.
- **Palico:** small, orange fur with a white blaze; name them **Spark**. Spoken voice, bright pitch.
- **Seikret:** flame colors — red-orange feathers with gold decoration.
- **Weapons:** start Dual Blades; carry Sword & Shield for mounts and flex matchups.
- **House rules:** stay in the monster's face — leaving the immediate melee range without a reason counts as a failed rule; create at least one wound per minute of combat; never let the weapon's sharpness drop below the middle bar mid-fight (Auto Sharpen only works between hunts — the Wildfire must manage it live).
- **Goal:** top the damage chart in every hunt — alone or alongside Support Hunters.
- **Mods that shine:** the Overlay (the scoreboard), Enhanced Damage Numbers (the feedback loop), Auto Restock (never stop for items), the visual stack for clarity at speed.

4.5 4 • The Skybound Warden

The Skybound Warden *Weapons: Insect Glaive → Hunting Horn · Focus: aerial mastery, extracts, and the field guide*

Background. The expedition's naturalist, armed. The Insect Glaive puts the Skybound Warden above the monster — harvesting extracts with the kinsect, vaulting over attacks, and reading the fight from the air, where the pattern is clearest. The Hunting Horn is the support identity: songs that make the whole party stronger, because the Warden believes the expedition is one creature. This is the persona for hunters who want to **understand** monsters — every hunt is a field study.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a curious, open face with light freckles or a faint sun-mark; tousled hair; warm voice, mid pitch. Name them for the sky — **Crane, Lark, Zenith**.
- **Palico:** soft, cream-colored fur, big eyes; name them **Moth**. Felyne language — they have their own research.
- **Seikret:** pale feathers with sky-blue tips, feather-pattern pendant.

- **Weapons:** start Insect Glaive; add Hunting Horn as the second for support play and hard walls.
- **House rules:** keep all three extracts up before engaging — no fights without the full trio; complete the field guide for every monster you hunt (weakness icons make this a checklist, not a chore); use the Support Hunter party at least once per session — the Warden hunts with the expedition.
- **Goal:** a complete field guide and a library of solo kills on every flying monster.
- **Mods that shine:** Monster Weakness Icon Indicator (the field guide at a glance), the Overlay (extract uptime and status buildup readouts), Better Camps (a camp network for the naturalist's routes).

4.6 5 • The Ember Artisan

The Ember Artisan *Weapons: Charge Blade → Switch Axe • Focus: technical mastery and the forge*

Background. The smithy's finest student, sent into the field to test what the forge makes. The Charge Blade is a machine of two halves — sword-and-shield charging phials, axe mode spending them — and mastering it is an apprenticeship in itself. Switch Axe is the second trade: morphing, phial management, and the explosive axe-mode finishers. The Ember Artisan fights like they forge: deliberate, hot, and precise. Gemma the smith approves of this persona.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a soot-smudged look (skin texture slider), strong jaw, hair tied back; low, measured voice. Name them for the forge — **Anvil, Bracket, Temper**.
- **Palico:** charcoal fur with amber eyes; name them **Slag**. Spoken voice, dry and low.
- **Seikret:** ember tones — deep brown with orange pattern, metal pendant.
- **Weapons:** start Charge Blade; carry Switch Axe for variety.
- **House rules:** every hunt must end with the weapon fully discharged — never leave phials unspent; craft at least one piece of gear from every monster you slay (the forge is the point); learn one new weapon combo per session in the training area.
- **Goal:** a fully upgraded weapon and armor set from every title-update monster — the artisan's catalogue.
- **Mods that shine:** Enhanced Damage Numbers (see phial damage vs. raw — the artisan's data), the Overlay (status buildup readout for phial decisions), Auto Meal (the forge runs on meals), the visual stack to admire the crafted gear.

4.7 6 • The Horizon Keeper

The Horizon Keeper *Weapons: Bow → Light Bowgun • Focus: the expedition's surveyor — exploration, gathering, weather*

Background. The expedition does not only hunt — it **maps**. The Horizon Keeper is the surveyor who knows every locale's weather cycle, every camp site, every gathering node worth a detour. Bow is the ranged identity: positioning, range discipline, and the patience of a shot held until the monster offers it. Light Bowgun is the second register — statuses and support shots from a safe distance. The Horizon Keeper wins hunts before they start: the right element, the right camp, the right weather, and a route that wastes nothing.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a sun-weathered face, practical short hair, calm eyes; even voice, mid-low pitch. Name them for the horizon — **Meridian, Farpoint, Bearing**.
- **Palico:** tawny fur, alert ears; name them **Compass**. Felyne language.
- **Seikret:** sand-and-sky colors — pale feathers with blue accents, utility pendant.
- **Weapons:** start Bow; carry Light Bowgun for status work.

- **House rules:** check the weather before every hunt and pick the right Inclemency for apex hunts; place a new pop-up camp in a locale you have not built in yet each session; gather on the way — every hunt route includes at least three gathering stops; use the weakness icons to plan the element **before** leaving camp.
- **Goal:** every camp site built in every locale, the field guide completed, and a solo bow kill of every Apex in its own Inclemency storm.
- **Mods that shine:** Monster Weakness Icon Indicator (planning), Better Camps + Auto Fix Camps (the surveyor's network), the fog tweak (see the apex through the storm), Auto Restock (loadout per weapon type — the surveyor's preps).

4.8 How to start a persona run

1. *Create the character* with the persona's choices above (or paste a matching creation code at creation).
2. *Name the save* forlorn-<persona> so the chronicles stay separate.
3. *Write the house rules on paper* — three lines of rules beat a forgotten promise in hour forty.
4. *Configure the QoL mods* for the persona's weapons — Auto Restock and Auto Meal loadouts per weapon type (Script Generated UI), so each persona's preparation is automatic and distinct.
5. *Hunt.* The first hunt with a new persona is the tutorial for that identity; the hundredth is the chronicle.

Persona	Weapons	Signature mods
The Warden of the Forlorn	Lance / Gunlance	Disable Near Fade, Overlay, Persistent Buff Glow Removal
The Storm's Edge	Long Sword / Great Sword	Overlay, Enhanced Damage Numbers, Disable Near Fade, fog tweak
The Wildfire	Dual Blades / Sword & Shield	Overlay, Enhanced Damage Numbers, Auto Restock
The Skybound Warden	Insect Glaive / Hunting Horn	Weakness Icons, Overlay, Better Camps
The Ember Artisan	Charge Blade / Switch Axe	Enhanced Damage Numbers, Overlay, Auto Meal
The Horizon Keeper	Bow / Light Bowgun	Weakness Icons, Better Camps, Auto Fix Camps, fog tweak